



Q

What minimum internal temperature must eggs reach to be considered safely cooked?



ANSWER

160°F, when both white and yolk are firm

FUN FACT

Cooking eggs to 160°F prevents Salmonella infection risks.

Source: PNW 720 Proper egg handling



Q

Why is it unsafe to alter tested home canning recipes, especially for low-acid foods?



ANSWER

Changes can affect acidity or processing time, risking botulism

FUN FACT

Botulinum spores can grow if acidity or heat treatment is insufficient.

Source: SP 50-714 Science of food preservation



Q

At what pH value and below do pathogenic bacteria like *Clostridium botulinum* not grow?



ANSWER

pH 4.6 and below

FUN FACT

High-acid foods like most fruits are naturally resistant to botulism growth.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



Q

What is one of the most important reasons to keep cooked foods out of the 'danger zone' temperature range of 40°F to 140°F?



ANSWER

Pathogenic bacteria grow fastest between 60°F and 125°F

FUN FACT

Keeping food out of the danger zone helps prevent foodborne illness.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



Q

Which food safety practice is essential before and after preparing eggs to avoid contamination?



ANSWER

Wash hands, utensils, and surfaces with soap and water

FUN FACT

Eggshells can carry Salmonella bacteria that contaminate kitchen surfaces.

Source: PNW 720 Proper egg handling



Q

Why should leftover cooked foods be refrigerated within 2 hours of cooking?



ANSWER

**To prevent bacteria growth
and keep food safe**

FUN FACT

*Bacteria can multiply quickly if foods
are left too long at room temperature.*

Source: PNW 250 You can prevent food borne
illness



Q

Which is a sign that home-canned food may be unsafe and should not be eaten?



ANSWER

**Bubbles rising in the jar,
off-odor, or bulging lid**

FUN FACT

Bulging lids can indicate dangerous bacterial gas production inside the jar.

Source: SP 50-490 Botulism



Q

What is an important step to prevent cross-contamination in the kitchen?



ANSWER

Wash knives and cutting boards with hot soapy water after raw meat contact

FUN FACT

Cross-contamination can spread harmful bacteria to ready-to-eat foods.

Source: PNW 250 You can prevent food borne illness



Q

Why are low-acid foods more dangerous in home canning than high-acid foods?



ANSWER

Low-acid foods allow growth of botulinum spores unless processed carefully

FUN FACT

Pressure canning is needed to safely process low-acid foods like vegetables and meats.

Source: SP 50-714 Science of food preservation



Q

How often should kitchen surfaces and food preparation areas be cleaned when handling raw poultry or meat?

FOOD SAFETY



Adults

ANSWER

Before and after each use with hot soapy water

FUN FACT

Frequent cleaning stops bacteria from spreading in your kitchen.

Source: PNW 250 You can prevent food borne illness



Q

Why is headspace important in home canning jars?



ANSWER

It allows proper heat circulation and vacuum sealing during processing

FUN FACT

Incorrect headspace can cause jars to not seal or food to spoil.

Source: SP 50-1010 Canning tip sheet



Q

What is the safe procedure for reheating leftovers to prevent illness?

FOOD SAFETY



Adults

ANSWER

Use a thermometer to reheat foods to 165°F throughout

FUN FACT

Reheating to proper temperature kills bacteria that can cause illness.

Source: PNW 250 You can prevent food borne illness



Q

What effect does proper acidity (low pH) have on home-canned foods?



ANSWER

It inhibits growth of harmful bacteria like Clostridium botulinum

FUN FACT

Acidifying foods with vinegar or lemon juice helps ensure safety in canning.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



Q

What is the recommended action if a sealed jar of canned food has lost its vacuum seal?



ANSWER

Reprocess the food immediately or refrigerate and use soon

FUN FACT

A lost vacuum seal indicates the food may not be safe to store long-term.

Source: SP 50-490 Botulism



Q

Why must fruits and vegetables be washed before preservation?



ANSWER

To remove dirt, microbes, and pesticides that can cause spoilage or illness

FUN FACT

Dirt or bacteria on fresh produce can contaminate preserved food if not washed off.

Source: SP 50-837 Kitchen cleanliness



Q

When is it safe to consume home-canned low-acid vegetables without botulism risk?



ANSWER

**Only after pressure canning
for recommended time and
temperature**

FUN FACT

*Pressure canning destroys botulinum
spores that boiling water can't kill.*

Source: SP 50-490 Botulism



Q

What is one key reason why pickles are usually safe to preserve with boiling water canning?



ANSWER

Their acidity is high enough (pH below 4.6) to prevent botulism

FUN FACT

The vinegar in pickles provides the acidity needed to safely preserve them.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



Q

What is the recommended storage temperature for eggs to prevent Salmonella contamination?



ANSWER

Below 40°F in the refrigerator

FUN FACT

Cold storage keeps Salmonella bacteria from multiplying on eggs.

Source: PNW 720 Proper egg handling



Q

Why is it important not to prepare foods too far in advance before serving without proper cooling?



ANSWER

Extended time at unsafe temperatures increases bacteria growth risk

FUN FACT

Plan food prep to keep perishable foods out of the danger zone as much as possible.

Source: PNW 250 You can prevent food borne illness



Q

Which of these is NOT a safe practice to prevent foodborne illness in home food preservation?



ANSWER

Using the same utensil for raw and cooked foods without washing

FUN FACT

Avoid cross-contamination by always using clean utensils for cooked foods.

Source: PNW 250 You can prevent food borne illness